

26PR00588 Estate of Melanie J. Stapper

County: sonoma

Division: Probate

Hearing date: 2026-06-26

Motion: Letters of Administration

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Estate of Melanie J. Stapper

26PR00588

Letters of Administration

Tentative Ruling: APPROVED. NO APPEARANCES REQUIRED. Bond is set in the amount of \$1,000,000.00. Petitioner is to file an Inventory and Appraisal within four months of issuance of letters (Prob. Code section 8800(b)) and either a petition for an order for final distribution of the estate or a report of status of administration within the timeframe set out in Probate Code section 12200.

The matter is SET on the August 26, 2027, probate case management conference calendar at 3:00 p.m. in Department 63 for status of estate or final account and distribution. No appearances at the hearing will be required if the court determines that administration of the estate is timely proceeding, or good cause is shown why more time is required.

The Court finds the request to change the authority issued to limited untimely in terms of notice and publication and notes the Court would require more than a nominal bond in any event.

The Court finds the declaration of diligent search sufficient for the opening of probate, but will require the hiring of professional heir finding services prior to any final distribution that does not include a distribution directly to all heirs.